

Rebecca Picanso

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<https://github.com/rebeccapicanso>

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Feb 2025 to August 2025	Backend Software Engineer - Dune Security <i>Early hire at a seed-stage security startup; built and maintained core backend systems, complex Go micro-services, and tailored client software. Built for 0 to 1.</i>	New York City, NY
	• Migrated application infrastructure from Django to Go-Fiber, refactored RESTful endpoints and MongoDB queries, achieving over 50% reduction in API response times. • Developed scalable API endpoints and AWS Lambda functions for email scheduling, phishing asset generation, simulation tracking, and admin portals. Integrated work with LLMs, genetic algorithms, and existing services and features via Bedrock, S3, DocumentDB, and RDS. • Owned end-to-end development of custom client software, from simulation design to deployment, executing multi-month client campaigns with tailored feature sets. • Led infrastructure improvements including ElastiCache (Valley, Redis) integration, advanced indexing, and database-level caching, to reduce query latency by up to 60% across critical services. Supported an AWS region migration and domain shift to enhance system reliability while maintaining SOC2 compliance.	
Jan 2024 to Dec 2024	Software Engineer - Assembly <i>Commercial post-production house; Led backend development, infrastructure, and DevOps during a high-demand, high-volume, critical transition period.</i>	New York City, NY
	• Reverse-engineered an external RESTful API in Python and Go to automate project backups into a PostgreSQL production database, saving Assembly a yearly \$250,000 in the application's cloud database. • Designed and maintained multiple RESTful APIs and PostgreSQL production databases. Built an RClone server in Go to facilitate secure, real-time data transfers between independent facilities with sha256 hash. • Contributed to an initiative to significantly reduce Engineering's CapEx, achieving a 60% reduction in costs through strategic software, hardware, and subscription optimizations. • Wrote scripts for deployment and domain binding, shared home directories between MacOS and Linux, and storage auto mounting. Utilized Grafana, Kubernetes, Docker, Ansible, and Prometheus. • Independently rebuilt an MDM without any disruption to through careful Python and Bash scripting. Created a completely "hands-off" enrollment of laptops, production machines, and servers - allowing the offline editorial department's clients to scale 3x without the need for additional engineering. • Upon company wind-down, assisted in the complete AWS cloud migration of client data and internal servers. Performed "health checks" on hardware, created documentation, implemented disaster recovery plans, and ensured the isolation and future success of Assembly's partner VFX company.	
May 2022 to Feb 2024	Software Systems Engineer - Technicolor, Postworks <i>Post-production subsidiary of the pioneer Technicolor Film; Developed Python automation tools and data pipelines to streamline video metadata handling and optimize storage.</i>	New York City, NY
	• Developed Python tools for managing and manipulating video metadata for SQL, MongoDB and PostgreSQL databases. • Automated data management processes, including storage optimization with Weka and LTO backup systems, while serving as the primary liaison between data and engineering teams. • Scripted automation pipelines for video and audio standardization, working within strict MPA security compliance, supporting high-profile productions and ensuring consistent quality across deliverables.	
Sept 2018- Sept 2020	Software Database Developer - MAXGallery <i>Internship (Fall 2018, Spring 2019, Fall 2019, Spring 2020).</i>	Baltimore, Maryland

EDUCATION AND FELLOWSHIPS

Jan 2025 — Feb 2025	Fellow, Recurse Center Began building ML compilers in Rust. Continued development of a to-be open sourced selection model that utilizes SciPy and Pandas to mimic a user's taste in images.	New York City, NY
Sep 2018 — Jul 2022	B.S. Computer Information Systems, University of Baltimore University of Baltimore's Computer Science program.	Baltimore, Maryland

EXTRA-CURRICULAR

Dec 2023 — Present	Assistant Director, Dunkunsthalles Internationally renowned gallery in FiDi, collaborating with MoMa, Rhizome, Meta, Pace Gallery, and NVIDIA to support the development of code-based and generative art.	New York City, NY
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